

Similarity and AI screening report

Original research · 6,200 words · iThenticate similarity index 22% · editor-read

This is a redacted sample. It shows the structure and level of detail of a real deliverable. Client names, journal names and identifying particulars have been removed or changed. Ask us and we will send one built around a manuscript like yours.

A similarity index is not a plagiarism score. 22% sounds alarming and is not. What matters is where the overlap sits, and how long the matched runs are. This report classifies every match above threshold rather than reporting a percentage.

Where the 22% comes from

Source of overlap	Share	Verdict
Your own earlier publications	9%	Leave. Self-overlap in methods is expected; cite the earlier paper.
Standard method descriptions	6%	Leave. Assay and instrument boilerplate cannot be usefully reworded.
Correctly quoted and cited material	3%	Leave. Quotation marks and citation present.
Reference list	2%	Leave. Excluded from the index in the corrected figure.
Genuine unattributed overlap	2%	Act. Four passages, detailed below.

Excluding references, quotation and boilerplate, the actionable figure is **2%**, across four passages. Three need a citation; one needs rewriting.

The four passages

Ref	Length	Action
p.4, lines 88–96	31 words	Cite. Close paraphrase of a published method; add the citation.
p.7, lines 155–161	24 words	Reword. Matches a review article almost verbatim with no citation.
p.11, lines 240–246	19 words	Cite. A definition taken from a guideline document.
p.14, lines 301–305	17 words	Quote. Attributable to a named source; quotation marks needed.

AI authorship screening

Overall likelihood: **low to moderate**, driven by two passages in the Discussion. A subject editor has read both against the surrounding text.

Our assessment is that the score reflects register rather than authorship. The flagged passages are conventional academic English with low lexical variety — exactly the profile detectors penalise in writing by non-native English speakers. Published evaluations put the false-positive rate for that group at around 61%, and Turnitin's own guidance states that an AI score should not be the sole basis for any adverse action.

What we recommend. No rewriting on the basis of the AI score. Keep your drafts and version history. If the journal raises it, respond with the process evidence rather than the text. Do not use a humanising or bypass tool — that creates the integrity problem you are trying to avoid.

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